

letter I'd seen that quoted Robert Byron, or Tacitus, or Kipling. For several years it had ranked in the top five newsletters in the country for profitable advice, according to Hulbert's *Digest*.

As to Mr. Frank's reputation for charm, candor, and humility, you'd get no argument from me. When I congratulated him on his good fortune, he quickly reminded me that good fortunes can change. When I asked if I should subscribe to his newsletter, he cautioned that "picking the right newsletter for all markets is no easier than picking the one right stock." He said many strange and wonderful things, such as "maybe I'm paranoid," "beware the tautology," "I have a curious appreciation for the logically absurd," and "I've never raped anybody."

This latter remark preceded an invitation to visit his room, where he promised to share some Fundamentalist beliefs. I was delighted to accept the invitation. As soon as I settled into the far chair, with Mr. Frank sprawled across the bed, the phone began to ring. It rang incessantly throughout my visit. The magazine interviewers finally had caught up with him, and for that, he of course apologized.

While Mr. Frank was being interviewed, I thumbed through The Book, a thick record of his current holdings, with evaluations of 130 or so companies whose shares he owned. I could see by the dates that many of these shares were purchased years ago. "Buy and hold" was one of his Fundamentalist rules.

Looking through the A's and disappointed not to see Angstrom, I spied Amfesco Industries, the closest thing in spelling. "What does this Amfesco do?" I asked Mr. Frank after he hung up the phone. "Who cares?" he said, bobbing on his bed. "I never remember what half these companies do." According to him, only an amateur would buy shares of Hershey because he liked Hershey bars, or invest in Subaru because he drove a Subaru, or choose any stock because of the company's reputation. This made me feel better about having bought Angstrom before I could remember its name.

Mr. Frank scoffed at Charting, though he admitted to having friends who were Chartists. Instead of wasting his time with wiggly lines, he searched the earnings reports for "undervalued companies," then bought their stock and waited for the companies to